

FREE KIT

The Time Travel *Video Kit*

The exact workflow and the exact prompts behind my London and Paris history reels: how to pick the moments, look like yourself in every era, render the clips, add the flipping calendar and save credits. Templates you can copy for your own city.

BY WOMEN LEAD AI · WOMENLEAD.AI

WHY THIS WORKS

Two cities, *200K+ views*

London Through Time

142,806

views, 99% from people who didn't follow me yet, 1,490 saves and 649 new followers

Paris Through Time

75,977

views, a 30 second average watch, 880 saves and 778 new followers

Instagram insights, 26 October 2026.

WHAT YOU NEED

- **A Higgsfield account** (higgsfield.ai). An 8 second Seedance 2.5 clip at 1080p costs 128 credits, a 5 second clip 80. Character sheets cost about 3 credits. Each city came to just over 1,000 credits plus a few redos.
- **2 or 3 clear photos of your face.** One straight on, one three quarter, natural light, no filters.
- **A plain character sheet of you**, made from those photos before any costume (page 6). Every era starts from it.
- **A list of real moments with real dates.** Fact check them before you build anything.
- **Claude Code** with the Higgsfield connector, to write the prompts, run the jobs, keep track of every job ID and stitch the final video. CapCut works too for the edit.
- **Free editing tools for Claude to stitch with:** Python 3, FFmpeg (it cuts, joins and encodes the video; ffprobe comes with it) and Pillow (a Python library that draws the calendar). Claude Code can install them for you (page 11).

THE SEVEN STEPS

1. Connect Higgsfield to Claude Code
2. Pick moments, not backdrops
3. Make a plain character sheet of you NEW
4. Make a character sheet for every era
5. Render the clips (two angles when you react)
6. Fix and save credits
7. Stitch it, add the calendar, plan the sound

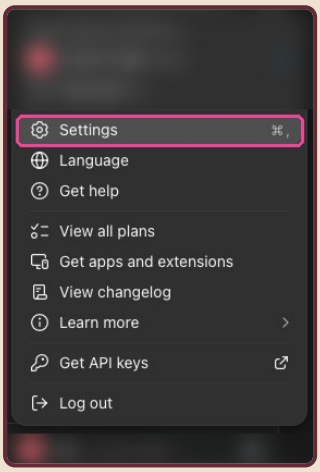
> **Every prompt in this kit comes twice:** the template with [BRACKETS] to fill in, and next to it the exact prompt I typed, word for word, so you can see what a finished one looks like.

Step 1

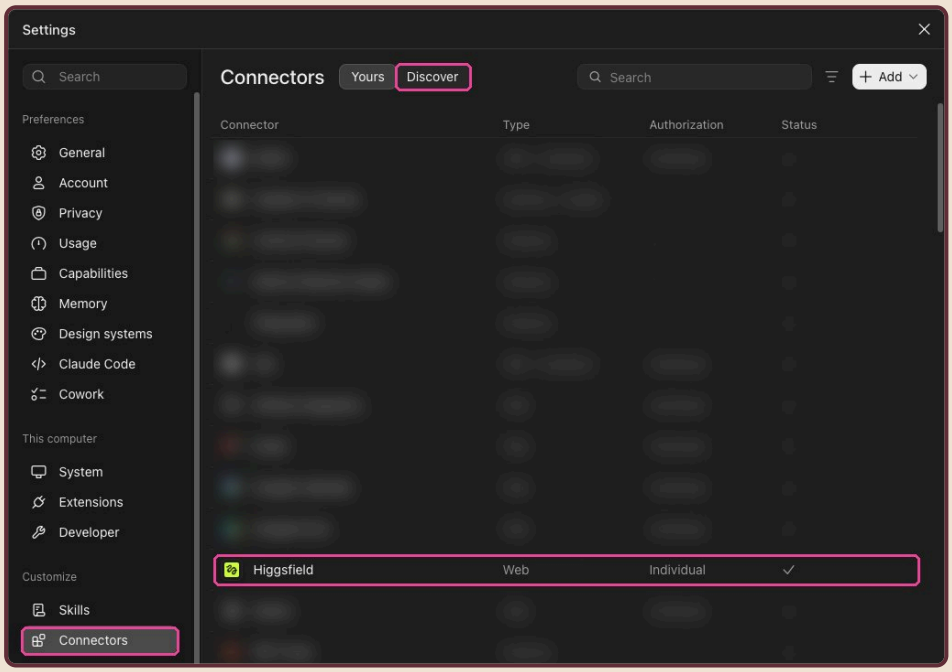
Connect Higgsfield *to Claude*

A connector lets Claude use Higgsfield for you, so you never copy prompts between apps. No account yet? Sign up for Higgsfield here, then:

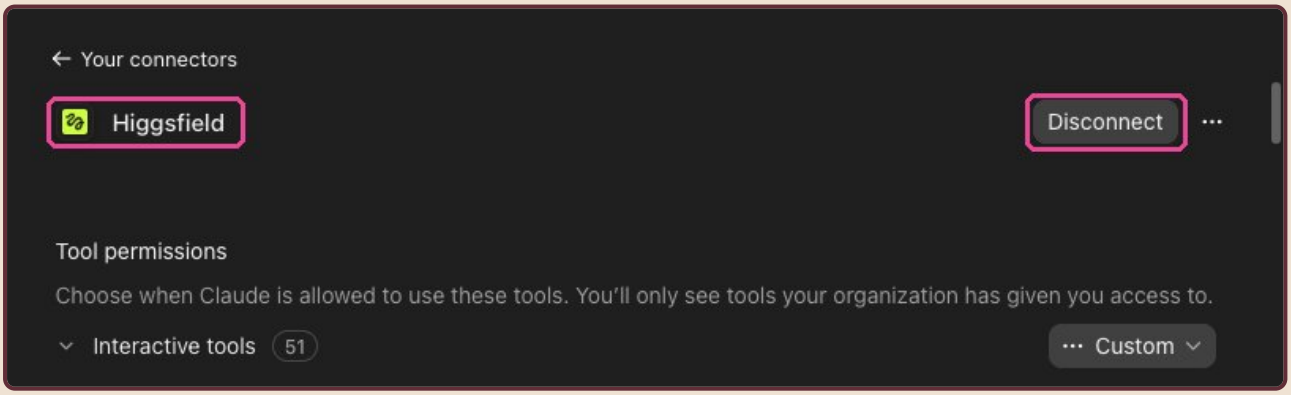
1. In the Claude app, click your name at the bottom left and open **Settings**.
2. Go to **Connectors** and click **Discover**.
3. Find **Higgsfield**, click connect and approve the Higgsfield sign in. It moves to **Yours** with a tick, and works inside Claude Code too.



1. Your name, then Settings



2. Connectors, then Discover. Once connected, Higgsfield sits in Yours



3. Connected: Higgsfield now shows a Disconnect button

Step 1, continued

Check it *and set up*

Check it works by asking:

```
What's my Higgsfield credit balance?
```

Then set up the project so changes stay cheap later:

TEMPLATE

```
Make a folder for my [CITY] Through Time video with
one subfolder per scene. Save every character sheet,
still and video into its scene folder, and keep a
JOBS.md file listing the job ID for each one. Before
every batch, tell me my balance and what it will
cost.
```

MINE, FOR PARIS

```
Make a folder for my Paris Through Time video with
one subfolder per scene. Save every character sheet,
still and video into its scene folder, and keep a
JOBS.md file listing the job ID for each one. Before
every batch, tell me my balance and what it will
cost.
```

> **Why the folder matters:** when you redo one scene, Claude already knows which sheet and face photos belong to it, so it only regenerates that one clip.

Step 2

Moments, *not backdrops*

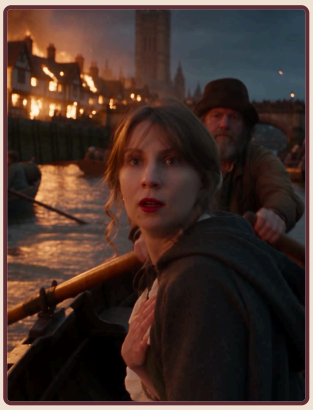
My first two London clips were me on a Roman wharf and outside a snowy abbey. They looked lovely and nothing happened, so people would scroll on. The rule that fixed it: **in every clip, the historic moment happens on camera in front of you.**



Backdrop: nothing happens



Backdrop: nothing happens



Moment: 1666, the city burns



Moment: 1918, the ballot goes in

Ask yourself: if I stood there on that day, what would I watch happen? A crown lowered, a bridge lifting, a ballot dropped, fireworks at midnight.

YOUR CITY

YEAR	DATE	WHAT HAPPENS ON CAMERA	COLOUR

TEMPLATE

```
Fact check these moments and dates for [CITY]. Flag
anything that's wrong, and tell me what visibly
happens in front of a bystander at each one.
```

MINE, FOR LONDON

```
Fact check these moments and dates for London. Flag
anything that's wrong, and tell me what visibly
happens in front of a bystander at each one.
```

Step 3

Start with *just you*

Before any costume, I made one character sheet of me exactly as I am: a full-length front view, a back view and a big close-up, in my own plain grey sweatshirt and trousers on a white background. No hats, no bonnets, no period hair.

This is the master reference. It shows the model my real face, hair, height and build with nothing hiding them, so every era sheet starts from the real me instead of the model's idea of me.



My plain character sheet: front, back and close-up, no costume

```
Character reference sheet of the woman in the reference photos, exactly as she is today. Keep her face EXACTLY as in the photos: [EYES], [HAIR COLOUR, LENGTH AND FRINGE], natural skin with real texture. Do not beautify, slim or change her face or body in any way.
Clothes: plain and simple, no logos: [e.g. a light grey sweatshirt, dark trousers, white trainers].
Layout on a plain white studio background: a full-length front view, a full-length back view and a large close-up portrait. Soft even studio light, photorealistic, natural proportions. No text, no labels, no watermark.
```

How I use it: I check every era sheet against it side by side, and it goes in as a reference next to my face photos when anything needs my whole look, like thumbnails and covers. If this sheet doesn't look like you, fix it now: nothing after it will look like you either.

Step 4

A sheet for *every era*

Now dress the same you for each moment: a big close-up, then front, side and back views on a plain grey background. Video models keep you consistent when they can see the whole outfit. In Higgsfield: **GPT Image 2.5**, 16:9, your 3 face photos as references.

TEMPLATE

```
Character reference sheet of the woman in the
reference photos, dressed as [WHO, WHERE, WHEN, e.g.
a London merchant's wife in September 1666]. Keep
her face EXACTLY as in the photos: [EYES], natural
skin with real texture, [LIP COLOUR FOR THE ERA]. Do
not beautify, slim or change her face in any way.
Costume, historically accurate for [PLACE AND YEAR],
in [ERA COLOUR]: [OUTFIT LINE]. Hair: her own [HAIR
COLOUR] hair [STYLE FOR THE ERA].
Layout on a plain warm light grey studio background:
on the left a large close-up portrait facing camera;
in the middle a full-length front view standing
naturally; then a full-length side view and a full-
length back view. Soft even studio light,
photorealistic photography, natural proportions,
real fabric texture. No text, no labels, no logos,
no watermark.
```

MINE, PARIS 1789, WORD FOR WORD

```
Character reference sheet of the woman in the
reference photos, dressed as a young working woman
of Paris on 14 July 1789, the day of the storming of
the Bastille. Keep her face EXACTLY as in the
photos: blue-grey eyes, natural skin with real
texture, a soft natural rose lip. Do not beautify,
slim or change her face in any way. Costume,
historically accurate for a Parisian working woman
in 1789: a fitted short indigo blue cotton caraco
jacket with elbow-length sleeves, a white muslin
fichu crossed over the chest and tucked in, a full
ankle-length skirt in red and cream vertical
stripes, a plain linen apron, a white linen mob cap
with a frilled edge and a green ribbon pinned to it
as a cockade, sturdy brown leather buckled shoes, a
small woven market basket on one arm. Hair: her own
light honey-brown hair loosely pinned up under the
cap with soft waves and her fringe just visible, a
few loose strands. Layout on a plain warm light grey
studio background: on the left a large close-up
portrait facing camera; in the middle a full-length
front view standing naturally; then a full-length
side view and a full-length back view. Soft even
studio light, photorealistic photography, natural
proportions, real fabric texture. No text, no
labels, no logos, no watermark.
```



My London 1666 sheet

Two rules: keep "do not beautify", and give every era its own colour (London: madder red, woad blue, bottle green, dusty rose, navy, plum). Check the sheet against your plain sheet before any video: a sheet costs about 3 credits, a clip 128.

Step 5

The video *prompt*

Seedance 2.5, reference mode, 1080p, 9:16, 8 seconds, audio on. References in this order: the character sheet first, then two face photos. The sheet is the costume, the photos are the face.

TEMPLATE

```
CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1
(character sheet) with the face from Reference
Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not beautified,
wearing exactly the costume from the character
sheet: [SHORT OUTFIT LINE]. ONLY she has this face;
every other person is a clearly different person
(mixed ages, builds, hair), nobody dressed like her.
HISTORIC MOMENT: [DATE], [THE EVENT IN ONE
SENTENCE].
SETTING: [PLACE, WEATHER, LIGHT, CROWD]. All paper
has no readable writing.
ACTION: [WHAT HAPPENS IN FRONT OF HER, SECOND BY
SECOND, AND HOW SHE REACTS].
CAMERA: one continuous shot, [MOVE], 9:16 vertical,
never cuts. Shot on ARRI Alexa 35, real depth of
field, photoreal.
AUDIO: [3 TO 5 SOUNDS FROM THE MOMENT], no music, no
speech to camera.
```

MINE, LONDON 1918, WORD FOR WORD

```
CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1
(character sheet) with the face from Reference
Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not beautified,
wearing exactly the costume from the character
sheet: long belted plum wool coat with a brown fur
collar, purple white and green rosette on the lapel,
cream high-necked blouse, wide dark felt hat, brown
leather gloves. ONLY she has this face; every other
person is a clearly different person (mixed ages,
builds, hair), nobody dressed like her.
HISTORIC MOMENT: 14 December 1918, the first general
election in which women in Britain can vote.
SETTING: a London polling station inside a school
hall on a grey winter morning: wooden floor, tall
windows with cold light, a Union flag on the wall, a
trestle table with two elderly male clerks in dark
suits and a ledger, a row of simple wooden voting
booths with curtains, a black metal ballot box with
a padlock and a slot on a table. Behind her a queue
of women of all ages in 1918 coats and hats waiting
their turn, among them a grey-haired older woman
with a purple, white and green sash under her coat.
All paper has no readable writing.
ACTION: she holds her folded ballot paper in her
gloved hand, steps up to the ballot box, pauses for
a breath, then pushes the paper through the slot;
she straightens up and breaks into a proud,
emotional smile, and the older woman in the queue
behind her nods and smiles back; a few women in the
queue clap quietly.
CAMERA: one continuous shot, starting close on her
gloved hand and the ballot paper going into the
slot, then a slow tilt and pull back to her face and
the queue of women behind her, 9:16 vertical, never
cuts. Shot on ARRI Alexa 35 with vintage lenses,
real depth of field, real fabric physics, soft grey
winter window light, slightly muted period colour,
photoreal.
AUDIO: footsteps on a wooden floor, the paper
sliding into the metal box, quiet murmurs, a few
gentle claps, a clock ticking, no music, no speech
to camera.
```



1066: monks chanting, bells



1894: the bridge lifts by second 3



2026: Big Ben, fireworks

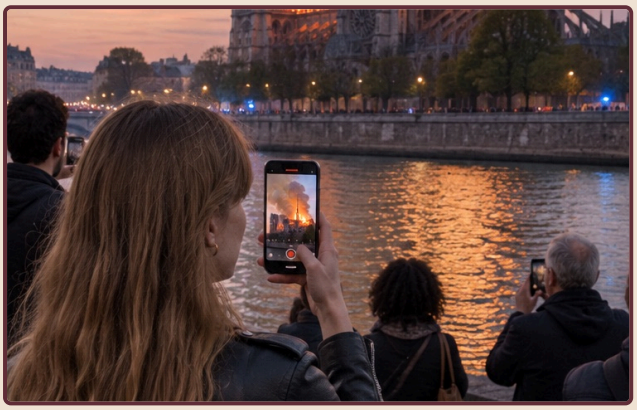
The lines doing the work: "only she has this face" stops background people looking like you. "Never cuts" keeps one shot. "No music, no speech" gives each clip its own soundscape. Each render takes 5 to 6 minutes: write the next prompt while it cooks.

Step 5, Paris upgrade

Face *the moment*

If you face the camera with the big event behind you, you look as if you're looking the wrong way. In Paris I shot those as two 5 second angles: one over my shoulder towards the event, one from the front with the event behind the camera, so my eyes point at what's happening.

```
Make this scene as two 5 second clips. A: camera behind her shoulder, we see what she sees. B: camera in front of her, the event is behind the camera, her eyes and the light on her face point at it. Same sheet, same face photos.
```



MINE, ANGLE A, WORD FOR WORD

```
Start exactly from the start frame. CHARACTER: the woman from the start frame, Reference Image 1 (character sheet) and the real photos, wearing exactly the outfit from the character sheet: black leather biker jacket, long loose wavy honey-brown hair. ONLY she has this face; every other person is a clearly different person. HISTORIC MOMENT: the evening of 15 April 2019, the fire at Notre-Dame de Paris. ACTION: seen over her shoulder, she stands at the quay wall filming the burning cathedral across the Seine on her phone; the flaming spire slowly tilts and collapses into the roof in a burst of sparks and smoke; she lowers the phone in shock, her hand drops; the people beside her gasp and cover their mouths, all still facing the cathedral. CAMERA: one continuous shot, over her shoulder from behind, slowly pushing in towards the burning cathedral as the spire falls, 9:16 vertical, never cuts. Shot on 35mm, dusk light with orange firelight reflected in the river, fine grain, real hair physics, photoreal, natural proportions, five fingers, no morphing. AUDIO: the low roar and crackle of a huge fire across the water, sirens, a crowd gasping in French with no clear words, no speech to camera, no music.
```



MINE, ANGLE B, WORD FOR WORD

```
Start exactly from the start frame. CHARACTER: the woman from the start frame, Reference Image 1 (character sheet) and the real photos, exactly this face in every frame, not beautified, wearing exactly the outfit from the character sheet: black leather biker jacket, striped Breton top, long loose wavy honey-brown hair with curtain bangs, red lips. ONLY she has this face; every other person is a clearly different person. HISTORIC MOMENT: the evening of 15 April 2019, the fire at Notre-Dame de Paris, which is in front of her, behind the camera and never visible. ACTION: close-up of her face lit by flickering orange firelight; she stares ahead past the lens at the fire with her hand over her mouth; a sudden brighter flare of orange light washes over her face as the spire falls, she flinches, her hand drops from her mouth, a tear runs down her cheek; behind her the out-of-focus people also react, looking the same way as her. CAMERA: one continuous very slow push in on her face, 9:16 vertical, never cuts. Shot on 35mm, warm orange firelight on her face against the cool blue dusk behind, shallow depth of field, fine grain, real hair physics, photoreal, natural proportions, five fingers, no morphing. AUDIO: the roar and crackle of a huge fire, distant sirens, a crowd gasping, someone quietly singing a hymn, no speech to camera, no music.
```

In Paris each angle started from a still (GPT Image 2.5, 9:16) made with the same sheet and face photos, so I could fix the scene for under a credit before paying for video.

Step 6

Fix it *cheaply*

Tell Claude what's wrong in plain English. It reuses the same sheet and face photos from JOBS.md and only regenerates that one clip.

```
In the 1894 clip the bridge doesn't lift until the last second. Make it start lifting by second
three. Same references, only redo this clip.
```

CREDIT CHECKLIST

- ☐ Check the plain sheet and each era sheet before the video (3 credits beats 128)
- ☐ Pick moments you can see before rendering anything
- ☐ Trim a mostly good clip instead of regenerating it
- ☐ Turn down presets Higgsfield suggests: they change the look
- ☐ Ask Claude for your balance and the cost before every batch
- ☐ Fact check dates first: a wrong date is a whole new clip

WHAT USUALLY NEEDS A REDO

Nothing happens	Rewrite the ACTION so the moment takes place in front of you
Wrong details	A flag or a crowd from the wrong decade: ask Claude to check costumes and props
Wrong eyeline	Split into two angles (page 9)
Doesn't look like you	Go back to the sheet, compare it with your plain sheet, and remake it before touching the video

Step 7

The calendar *and the sound*



Once the clips are in their folders, Claude Code writes a small Python script that joins them at full quality with FFmpeg and draws a hanging paper calendar with Pillow that flips at every cut. Because it's a script, Paris reused it almost unchanged.

First, once only, check the tools are there:

```
Check whether Python 3, FFmpeg (with ffprobe) and the Pillow
library are installed on my computer. Install whatever is missing,
and tell me each step before you run it.
```

Then the edit. This is what I typed:

```
Stitch the scene videos in order, keep their original audio, no
music. Add a vintage paper calendar in the top corner showing the
year, the date and the event name, and flip it to the next year at
every cut, riffling through some years in between on the big
jumps, with a paper flip sound each time. Keep it away from my
face.
```

On a Mac, Claude usually installs FFmpeg with Homebrew and Pillow with pip. You can approve each command.

PLAN THE SOUND LIKE THE PICTURES

- **Each clip's own audio underneath:** hooves and horns, bells, fire, Big Ben. It makes you feel you're standing there.
- **A paper flick on every calendar flip** ties the cuts together.
- **A track people recognise on top** (London used Viva la Vida, added in the Instagram editor). On YouTube a commercial song will likely get a Content ID claim, so keep it to the Instagram version.

Make it *with us*

Inside Women Lead AI we break down workflows like this every week, with women building real things with AI.

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